

HMF Design Clinic Grading Guide

A case study score, an overall score, and qualitative feedback on three dimensions

Score each case study across its four pain points, out of 100, for an overall total of 400. Alongside the score, assess each team on three dimensions and record qualitative feedback. Use the Solution Guide for the model answers.

The three dimensions

Problem Identifier Correctly identified the customer's pain point and the requirements behind it.	Solution Designer Recommended the right Cisco solution, architecture, and approach.	Value Communicator Clearly explained how the solution works and the customer outcomes it enables.
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How it works. For each case study, read the team's four answers, assess them on the three dimensions using the scale below, and assign a **case study score out of 100**. Add the four case study scores for an **overall score out of 400**. Grade against the Solution Guide and reward reasoning specific to Cedarline.

The assessment scale

Strong	Consistently meets the dimension across the case study; specific to Cedarline.
Developing	Solid, but with gaps or generic reasoning in places.
Emerging	Early. The idea is there but thin, partial, or unclear.

From ratings to a score

Use the overall picture across the three dimensions to place the case study score in a range.

Mostly Strong	85 to 100 / 100
Mostly Developing	65 to 84 / 100
Mostly Emerging	40 to 64 / 100
Below Emerging	under 40 / 100

1 Case Study 1

THE FOUR PAIN POINTS ASSESSED

1. Under the EU AI Act, we are classified as a 'Provider' for our internal AI systems. We need to demonstrate...
2. We are integrating various open-source models and third-party agents into our internal workflows. How can...
3. We know AI is showing up across our cloud environments faster than security can track it. We're worried we...
4. We're running AI workloads in cloud accounts, but we don't have a reliable way to see which models and AI...

DIMENSION	ASSESSMENT (CIRCLE ONE)	NOTES
Problem Identifier	Strong Developing Emerging	
Solution Designer	Strong Developing Emerging	
Value Communicator	Strong Developing Emerging	

Case Study 1 score _____ / 100

Strengths and coaching for this case study

2

Case Study 2

THE FOUR PAIN POINTS ASSESSED

1. If a breach occurs in one of our public cloud instances, we are terrified that the attacker will move...
2. Our auditors require proof that our security controls are applied consistently across all our cloud...
3. We have workloads spread across AWS, Azure, and on-premises data centers. Managing security policies...
4. We have workloads on-prem, in cloud, and in mixed environments, and policy consistency is becoming...

DIMENSION	ASSESSMENT (CIRCLE ONE)	NOTES
Problem Identifier	Strong Developing Emerging	
Solution Designer	Strong Developing Emerging	
Value Communicator	Strong Developing Emerging	

Case Study 2 score _____ / 100

Strengths and coaching for this case study

3

Case Study 3

THE FOUR PAIN POINTS ASSESSED

1. When our security tools detect a compromised device, our manual response time is too slow. By the time we...
2. Our firewall environment has become too complex to manage manually.
3. Most of our traffic is encrypted, so we've lost visibility into a huge part of our environment.
4. We're worried traditional signature-based detection won't catch new or unknown attacks quickly enough.

DIMENSION	ASSESSMENT (CIRCLE ONE)	NOTES
Problem Identifier	Strong Developing Emerging	
Solution Designer	Strong Developing Emerging	
Value Communicator	Strong Developing Emerging	

Case Study 3 score _____ / 100

Strengths and coaching for this case study

4

Case Study 4

THE FOUR PAIN POINTS ASSESSED

1. Network policy helps, but we also need to know what's happening at runtime inside the workload. We need...
2. Our Kubernetes networking feels fragmented across clusters and environments. We're dealing with too many...
3. Right now we're stitching together separate tools for networking, security, and observability in...
4. We know we need microsegmentation, but we don't have enough visibility into east-west flows or application...

DIMENSION	ASSESSMENT (CIRCLE ONE)	NOTES
Problem Identifier	Strong Developing Emerging	
Solution Designer	Strong Developing Emerging	
Value Communicator	Strong Developing Emerging	

Case Study 4 score _____ / 100

Strengths and coaching for this case study

Team total

Team _____ Event _____

CASE STUDY	SCORE / 100
Case Study 1	_____
Case Study 2	_____
Case Study 3	_____
Case Study 4	_____
Overall total	_____ / 400

Topology diagram: SME review. The team's Hybrid Mesh Firewall diagram is submitted for Subject Matter Expert review and is not part of the score. Reviewed by SME: Yes ☐ No ☐

Overall qualitative feedback

Strengths across the clinic

Priorities to develop
